Great Swamp Bonsai Society

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September, 2005 Newsletter

Next Meeting : 7:00 pm Tuesday, September 20th at the Arboretum.

July Meeting Highlights:

Our July meeting featured a tropical demonstration by **George LeBolt** from Bergen Bonsai. George worked his magic on a somewhat unruly looking ficus of his choosing.

Here are some Highlights:

Start to Finish...

The President's Corner:

Mark Schmuck

Hi folks!

I hope every one enjoyed their summer, it was a beauty...

Just a few reminders:

1. Our September meeting is the **third** Tuesday this month.
2. Dues are due,
3. There are still a couple spots open for the Roy Nagatoshi workshop. Call me at (973) 625-4632 to sign up,
4. Walter Pall from Germany will headline our October meeting; The next day, Walter will be at Marty's Stillwater Studio for workshops (50$), not a bad deal! Those interested call Marty at 973-383-8377.

See you at the meeting,

Mark

Upcoming Events: **(items marked with a •W denote a workshop)**

•W **September 20**. Third Tuesday. There will be an afternoon workshop with Roy Nagatoshi from California. Members Only, $50 per person. Bring your own tree. In the evening, Roy will conduct a lecture/demo on an as yet unpicked tree, to be raffled at the conclusion of the meeting. Roy's trees were prominently featured in the Karate Kid films.

October 11. Walter Pall from Germany will be at our meeting.

•W **October 12.** Walter Pall at Marty Schmalenberg's Stillwater Studio for Workshop ($50)
Contact Marty at 973.383-8377 to make arrangements and for further details.

NOTE:

Unless otherwise specified, all of the Great Swamp afternoon workshops are held at the Arboretum, in Classroom "A" from 1:00 pm to 4:00 pm., members only, 6 to 8 people, $50 per person, bring your own tree.

And don't forget our website www.arboretumfriends.org/gsbonsai .
Follow the links to the Newsletter.

August Picnic:

The picnic was a success even though we got rained out earlier than we expected. Many members attended and food was to be found in quantities sufficient to satisfy the hungriest of our kind.

Unfortunately, your newsletter editor did not take any pictures at the event. Perhaps some other members did and, if they would be so kind as to forward them to me, I'll gladly include them in the next newsletter. My e-mail address can be found on page 3..

Thanks in advance.

It's September and Dues are Due once again: See Fred at the meetings.

September Plant Care Tips.

The weather should be starting to cool down a bit, giving our precious trees a break from the past ssummer's sweltering heat. Those trees that survived (and we hope that means ALL of your trees) certainly deserve the cooler weather that's coming..

Growth slows to a standstill. Roots and buds will harden as seeds are dispersed and inner leaves begin to fall. The first hints of Autumn color will start to show due to warm days and cool nights. It's time to start to relax.

Prune only Pines now if you must. Deciduous trees may still be fooled into growth, but any new buds will be gone after the first frost.

No need to trim things now other than the Junipers. They will continue on into the beginning of next month. But remember, newly pinched shoots will turn brown.

It's not advisable to do any heavy wiring now because without new growth, branches will not set and any damage to the bark and structure of the branches may let in frost during the winter and cause additional damage..

Your trees are beginning to require less water now so you may slow down the watering. Remember though, trees can still dry out quickly on those abnormally hot, sunny days. So beware of that.

Feed with nitrogen-free fertilizer all month. Add some additional bone meal to pines, whose root systems will remain active throughout the winter. They will appreciate the extra boost come spring.

This will be the last opportunity to be creative with Jin and Shari while the sap is still flowing. Later on, you'll find the bark much more difficult to loosen and remove and wounds will not begin to heal until spring. While most pests are slowing down, be alert to certain active ones on conifers. (Persist3nt buggers, aren't they...).

Remove leaf litter and other debris from both the trees and soil surface to prevent any diseases from taking hold of your trees. Collected seeds may be sown outdoors. Moss planted now will continue to grow during warm spells and will be well-established for spring. Try to limit your moss planting to the areas around roots. Too much of a good thing will tend to harbor pests and prevent you from doing a good inspection of the "grounds".

- Tips taken from *Growing & Displaying Bonsai* by Colin Lewis and Neil Sutherland and from *Bonsai, the Art of Growing and Keeping Miniature Trees* by Peter Chan

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Ideas and offers of assistance for events, or scheduling questions, can be addressed to any of the officers. Don't be shy. Any and all help would be appreciated.